Fat Pig

By Neil LaBute

NOTE: This cutting asks one student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Suggested Roles: *ACTOR: Tom*
ACTRESS: Helen, (voices of Carter & Jeannie during Tom's monologues)

Helen in a crowded restaurant, standing at one of those tall tables. A bunch of food in front of her, and she is quietly eating it. By the way, she's a plus size. Very. After a moment Tom enters, juggling a lunch tray. He looks around, then moves toward her

TOM: **(Pg 5)** . . . pretty big.

HELEN: Excuse me?

TOM: I'm sorry, I was just sort of, you know, speaking out loud. Pretty big in here. That's what I was saying . . . Lots of room for, you know, people. *(Looks around, trying to see if there's a spot for him)*

HELEN: You can eat here if you want. *(She stares at him a minute, then slides some of her food to one side, allowing him a space)* **(Pg 6-7)** I thought you mean me. Before. When you said that, "pretty big," I though you were saying that to me. About me.

TOM: Oh, no, God, no! I wouldn't . . . that'd be . . . you know. Rude.

HELEN: You'd be surprised. People say all kinds of things.

TOM: So . . . you mean, people actually . . . what? Say things to your face?

HELEN: Of course. All the time. It's not a huge deal – I was just mentioning it. You get used to it. I guess they think that – I don't know, after a certain size or whatever . . .

TOM: Hey, you know . . . It's your . . .

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HELEN: How does that sentence end?

TOM: Badly, I'm sure! Hell, it's your body, you do what you want. That's what I think . . . I mean, look at me. . . . look how much chicken they put on my salad!

HELEN: So, do you really like sprouts or does that only hold true for me? *(He laughs at this, and she joins in. Tom studies her)*

TOM: **(Pg 9-10)** You have a terrific laugh.

HELEN: Thanks. The pizza's terrific here. I come by all the time for it . . .

TOM: I'll bet. *(Looks over at her)* I just me . . . you know. If it's so good. I would understand . That. *(Beat)* Please help me.

HELEN: I get what you meant. You shouldn't be so nervous . . . I mean, if we're gonna start dating.

TOM: What?

HELEN: I'm kidding. *(They laugh together. He looks around, self-consciously)* I'm sorry. You should 've seen your face . . . I though you were gonna choke on your avaocado there . .

TOM: That's not true . . . come on. You just caught me off guard is all. Seriously.

HELEN: Anyway, I was just playing. Big people are jolly, remember? It's one of our best qualities.

INTRODUCTION

***TOGETHER**: Fat Pig by Neil LaBute.*

HELEN: **(Pg 11)** *(Opens a pudding)* You want one?

TOM: Nah, I shouldn't . . .

HELEN: Why?

TOM: Excellent question. Okay. *(He takes a tub of pudding from her an digs in.)* Mmmmmm . . . wonderful. Haven't done that in ages.

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HELEN: What?

TOM: Enjoyed myself. Like that. Put something in my mouth without reading the back label like some Bible scholar . . . *(He gives an example – holding the pudding up to the light as if it was an antiquity and squinting at it. Examining it from all angels. This makes her laugh again. A lot)* **(Pg 13)** Listen, I'm . . . I need to get back to the office . . but could we . . . I dunno what I'm asking here. Should we see each other again? *(He reaches out for Helen's hand)*

HELEN: **(Pg 14)** *(Smiles)* . . . . Helen. My name's Helen. **(Pg 13)** Yes. We should. **(Pg 28)** You have my hand there, you know.

TOM: Yeah, I . . . is that not . . . ?

HELEN: It's fine. Just wanted to ask and see if it was an accident or not.

TOM: Ummm . . . no. It wasn't, no. But . . . now you're making me self-conscious. *(Tom looks around the restaurant)* **(Pg 13)** Lunch? Or, ummmm, dinner . . . ?

HELEN: I don't ***only*** eat. I can be coaxed into doing other stuff too . . . **(Pg 14)** *(She reaches over and takes a pen out his shirt pocket and writes her number down on a napkins)*

TOM: Of course! I didn't mean . . .

HELEN: I know. It's a joke. **(Pg 31)** Ummmm, you probably couldn't guess, but I didn't date a lot when I was in school. *(whispers)* I used to be a touch heavy. *(Helen chuckles. Tom joins in halfheartedly, then stops)*

TOM: **(Pg 14)** No, yes, I get it now . . . but you shouldn't do that though. Make fun of yourself so much.

HELEN: **(Pg 31-32)** It's not a shame thing for me. Not anymore.

TOM: "Anymore?"

HELEN: Well . . . it's all shame when you're younger, isn't it? You hate how you look. But I'm pretty all right with who I am now. The trick is getting other people to be okay with it!

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TOM: *(Tom looks at her in admiration)* **(Pg 13)** I'll call you. And I'm Tom, by the way. *(Helen exits She will provide Carter and Jeannie's lines from off stage as if they are echoing in Tom's head)* *(Tom to audience)* **(Pg 52)** I just took her out a few . . . she's nice. Okay?

JEANNIE: **(Pg 67)** She's really fat, Tom! A fat sow and you know it.

TOM: **(Pg 53)** She's not all worried about [weight], buying into all those dietary fads. Which is sort of refreshing, actually . . . Because you know . . .

CARTER: **(Pg 45)** Oh-my-God – I gotta go find my camera . . . "Tommy Joins the Circus!"

TOM: *(To audience)* **(Pg 53)** Yeah, I think she's pretty as well, but we don't ever talk about that. She's happy with who she is and so . . . it's . . . **(Pg 52)** *(Pulls a snapshot out of his wallet)*

CARTER: **(Pg 53-54)** *(Peering over Tom's shoulder)* If she lost, like, eighty pounds, she'd be kinda stunning. Could probably get on one of those reality shows

TOM: *(To audience)* **(Pg 56)** Seriously, I haven't felt this way for a long time. Ever, probably. I mean it. *(Beat)* . . . This is completely different. **(Pg 67)** She's not obsessed with looks and money and clothes and useless bullshit like that. *(Beat)* I like who I am when I'm with her . . . .

JEANNIE: **(Pg 66)** You know what everybody is saying, right? And it doesn't even faze you, huh? At all?

TOM: *(To audience)* **(pg 71)** I dunno, I like her. A lot. She makes me happy, and I really wanna make her happy too. Things aren't just based on appearance!

CARTER: **(Pg 49)** Take a look in the mirror, you cow!! You don't like being fat, there's a pretty easy remedy. Do-no-jam-so-much-food-in-your-gullet. It's not that hard

TOM: *(To audience)* Right. I guess that's true. *(Beat)* It's confusing, though. I wanna be better at that sorta stuff, but a lot of the time I'm just . . . yeah. A big wuss and I hate that! Despise that about me, but God, it's . . . . No I'm gonna work on it, I'll . . . I'll . . *(Scene shift)*

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HELEN: **(Pg 56-57)** So, you feel comfortable with me? I mean . . .

TOM: I adore you. This feels so damn good! You know? I mean . . . just us together. All alone. It's like we're on a raft of something. No one around to bug us. Ahhhhh, this is the life!

HELEN: I dunno, I just . . . I do feel kind of isolated. At times.

TOM: Helen . . . haven't I been with you every day? I mean my friends have even noticed it. I'm hardly with them anymore.

HELEN: But . . . that's what I mean. (Pg 58-59) I mean, we've been going out for like . . . however long, and I only met that one guy. Carter.

TOM: That's true, but . . . I've been waiting for the right time or something. One of those office parties or . . . maybe on the Fourth or . . . we do a big party at the beach. A cookout and stuff.

HELEN: Great . . . should I go with a thong, or be a little more conventional?

TOM: Very funny. I was being serious . . . *(a silence drops over them)*

HELEN: It's just a little like we're, I dunno, hiding or whatever from people. Every time we end up in the back of a café or slipping into a movie late, after it's already going – some little thing in my head, this warning buzzer says, "Watch it. Just watch out."

TOM: Helen . . .

HELEN: I just hope you're not embarrassed by me in some way, because . . . I don't know what . . .

TOM: No. Why would you say that? I'm not at all . . . *(Scene break and actors pantomime getting settled on the day of the beach party)* **(Pg 79-83)** I just wanted to get us near the dunes here, so we'd have a little protection from the wind, that's all.

HELEN: But we haven't . . . we didn't hardly talk to –

TOM: I introduced you to people . . .

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HELEN: In the parking lot! As you and I were unloading stuff out of the car. That's not an introduction.

TOM: Shit. I knew this would happen!

HELEN: You knew it would happen because you know who you are. I don't think you're ready for this. Tom . . . what's going on?

TOM: Helen, come on, stop now! Shit . . . this is my company picnic, okay? We're supposed to be having some fun.

HELEN: "Fun." Okay . . . Let go join in the big [volleyball] game. *(Helen jumps up and down a few times, miming s a few shots as Tom watchers. He looks over to where his friends are.)* Come on, Tom! It's fun!!

TOM: Stop it! Stop!! *(Looks around to make sure not one is watching)* Helen, please stop that.

HELEN: It is pretty obvious that there are some problems here. Tom, tell me about it. I know you're thinking something, so we might as well just . . . One more thing. Just this. And I've never said this to anyone, not any other person in the world. Ever . . . I would change for you. I don't mean Slim-Fast or that one diet that the guy on TV did . . . with the sandwiches from Subway.

TOM: Helen . . . that . . that's not . .

HELEN: I'll do something radical to myself if you want me to. Like being stapled or having some surgery or whatever it takes – because I do not want this to end. I just wanted you to know that. *(Tom looks off in silence)* This would be an excellent time to say something sweet to me. IF you at all care about my feelings.

TOM: I know. I'm . . . *(Beat)* Helen, that was such a nice thing to offer. And I appreciate it so much. *(Tries to smile)* Look, Helen . . . I've been thinking. *(Beat)* Listen . . . If we were in some other time or a land that nobody else was around one – then everything might be okay. I wouldn't be so paranoid about what the

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people around me were saying. Or even thing. Then it could just be you and me, and that'd be so great. Perfect. But . . . I guess I do care what my peers feel about me. And maybe that makes me not very deep or petty or . . .

HELEN: Tom, don't do this, okay? Please don't. *(Helen begins to cry and exits. She will provide Carter and Jeannie's lines from off stage as if they are echoing in Tom's head)*

TOM: *(To audience)* I want to be better, but I . . . I can't

CARTER: **(Pg 44)** Fat.

JEANNIE: Huge. A pig!

TOM: **(Pg 83)** *(To audience)* I mean, I could barely drive here today because my hands were shaking the whole time. . . .

CARTER: **(Pg 48)** I know what it's like, I mean, why you [are] so embarrassed

TOM: **(Pg 83)** *(To audience)* And these are all the people that I know! I'm just not gonna be able to do this, on like, a daily basis.

JEANNIE: **(Pg 67)** And forgive me for saying it, but she seems a little obsessed with some things . . . like maybe Cheetos.

TOM: **(Pg 83)** *(To audience) (Starts to cry)* God . . . look at me! All this love inside and it's not nearly enough to get around the shit that people heave at you . . . I feel like I'm drowning in it. I'm not brave. **(Pg 84)** I'm a weak and fearful person and I'm not gonna get any better.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2017 National Qualifier
IL State Qualifier
(*Likely a different cutting between only Helen and Tom)